



MENTAL MODELS · 04

The Compression Lens

Every summary is a choice about what to leave out.



Every AI summary is a compression.
And compression always throws
something away.



The question is never 'is this summary accurate' — it's 'what did this compression decide didn't matter, and do I agree?'



A good summary compresses along
the axis you care about.



A bad one compresses along whatever axis was statistically convenient for the model — and they can look identical on the page.



Before acting on an AI summary of a contract, a research transcript, a codebase — ask what got compressed out.



**It's usually the part you actually
needed.**

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